

Absolutely — **lemon** is a very good polysemy target because your passage uses it literally as a **fruit plant/tree**, while modern English also uses **lemon** for the fruit itself, the colour, and figuratively for a **defective product**, especially a vehicle.

Word family: **lemon / lemony / lemonade / lemon-coloured**

Base word: lemon

Plural: lemons

Related forms: lemony

Useful lexical extensions: lemonade, lemon tree, lemon juice, lemon zest, lemon curd, lemon law

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / adjective-related uses (相關形容詞)

Your sentence:

> “She also has a few fruit plants, especially strawberries and a small **lemon tree**.”

Meaning in your passage: **lemon tree = 檸檬樹**

Here **lemon** identifies the type of fruit produced by the tree.

繁體中文：

結出檸檬果實的柑橘類果樹

Natural translation:

> “She has a small lemon tree.”

「她有一棵小小的**檸檬樹**。」

So here:

> **lemon = 用來指明這棵樹所結的水果種類；檸檬**

1. **lemon = citrus fruit (水果) — 檸檬**

The central literal meaning.

Practice 1

> “She picked a ripe **lemon** from the tree.”

「她從樹上摘了一個成熟的**檸檬**。」

Practice 2

> “Add half a lemon to the drink.”

「在飲品中加入半個**檸檬**。」

****lemon = 一種黃色、味酸、富含果汁的柑橘類水果****

2. ****lemon tree (植物) — 檸檬樹****

This is your exact source use.

Practice 3 — Original

> “She has a small ****lemon tree****.”

「她有一棵小小的****檸檬樹****。」

Practice 4

> “The lemon tree needs plenty of sunlight.”

「****檸檬樹****需要充足陽光。」

Practice 5

> “Her lemon tree produced fruit for the first time this year.”

「她的****檸檬樹****今年第一次結果。」

****lemon tree = 結出檸檬果實的柑橘類果樹****

3. ****lemon = pale yellow colour (顏色) — 檸檬黃色；淡黃色****

A genuine noun/adjective-like colour use.

Practice 6

> “She painted the kitchen ****lemon yellow****.”

「她把廚房漆成**檸檬黃色**。」

Practice 7

> “He wore a pale **lemon** shirt.”

「他穿了一件淡**檸檬黃色**的襯衫。」

lemon — colour = 類似檸檬果皮的明亮或偏淡黃色

Common:

* lemon yellow

* lemon-coloured

4. **a lemon = defective product (產品) — 有嚴重毛病的次貨 ; 問題產品**

This is the most important figurative meaning.

Especially in American English, **a lemon** can mean:

> **a product, especially a car, that has serious defects and repeatedly causes problems.**

Practice 8

> “The used car turned out to be a **lemon**.”

「那輛二手車原來是一部**毛病多多的次貨 / 問題車**。」

Practice 9

> “I regret buying this laptop — it’s a complete lemon.”

「我後悔買了這部手提電腦——它根本是一件**問題產品 / 次貨**。」

a lemon = 購買後才發現品質很差、故障頻繁或有重大缺陷的產品

Register: informal, especially American English.

5. **lemon law (法律 / 消費者保障) — 檸檬法 ; 瑕疵車 / 問題產品保障法**

A very useful family extension from #4.

Practice 10

> “The buyer sought protection under the state’s **lemon law**.”

「買家根據該州的**檸檬法 / 瑕疵車保障法**尋求保障。」

Practice 11

> “Lemon laws may protect consumers who repeatedly receive defective vehicles.”

「**檸檬法**可能保障購買到屢次出現重大故障車輛的消費者。」

lemon law = 為購買到持續存在嚴重缺陷的車輛或某些產品的消費者提供補救的法律制度

Exact scope varies by jurisdiction.

6. **lemony** = tasting/smelling like lemon — 有檸檬味 / 香氣的

A useful related adjective.

Practice 12

> “The sauce has a fresh **lemony** flavour.”

「這個醬汁帶有清新的**檸檬味**。」

Practice 13

> “The leaves give off a slightly **lemony** scent.”

「葉子散發出淡淡的**檸檬香氣**。」

lemony = 味道或香氣具有明顯檸檬特徵的

7. **lemonade** = drink made with lemon — 檸檬水 ; 檸檬飲品

A common lexical extension.

Practice 14

> “She made fresh **lemonade** from the lemons in her garden.”

「她用花園裡的檸檬做了新鮮**檸檬水**。」

Practice 15

> “A glass of cold lemonade is refreshing on a hot day.”

「炎熱天氣喝一杯冰凍**檸檬水**很清爽。」

lemonade = 以檸檬汁、水和通常糖分製成的飲品

Regional note:

* American English often means still lemon drink.

* British English may also use **lemonade** for a clear fizzy lemon-flavoured soft drink.

8. **lemon juice (食材) — 檸檬汁**

Practice 16

> “Add a little **lemon juice** to the salad.”

「在沙律中加入少量**檸檬汁**。」

Practice 17

> “Lemon juice can add acidity to a dish.”

「**檸檬汁**可以為菜式增加酸味。」

lemon juice = 從檸檬果肉擠出的汁液

9. **lemon zest (烹飪) — 檸檬皮屑**

Practice 18

> “The cake contains fresh **lemon zest**.”

「蛋糕加入了新鮮的**檸檬皮屑**。」

Practice 19

> “Grate some lemon zest into the sauce.”

「在醬汁中刨入一些**檸檬皮屑**。」

lemon zest = 檸檬外層黃色果皮磨出的細屑，用來增加香氣

10. **lemon curd (食品) — 檸檬凝乳醬；檸檬醬**

A useful culinary compound.

Practice 20

> “She spread **lemon curd** on toast.”

「她在多士上塗了**檸檬凝乳醬 / 檸檬醬**。」

Practice 21

> “The tart was filled with lemon curd.”

「撻裡填滿了**檸檬醬**。」

lemon curd = 以檸檬、糖、蛋和脂肪等製成的濃稠甜酸醬

11. **when life gives you lemons... (比喻) — 遇到逆境時設法轉化成好事**

A very common idiom worth flagging.

> **When life gives you lemons, make lemonade.**

Meaning:

遇到不理想或困難的情況時，設法利用它、把它轉化成有利結果。

Practice 22

> “She lost her job but started her own business — when life gives you lemons, make lemonade.”

「她失業後創業，真是**遇到逆境也懂得把壞事變成機會**。」

Practice 23

> “He tried to make the best of the situation: when life gives you lemons, make lemonade.”

「他努力善用逆境，正所謂**遇到壞事也要想辦法轉化成好事**。」

I would keep this under **idioms/fixed expressions**, not treat it as another meaning of bare **lemon**.

Important distinction: **lemon vs lime**

lemon

usually:

- * yellow when ripe;
- * generally larger;
- * distinctive sour citrus flavour.

lime

usually:

- * green or yellow-green;
- * typically smaller;
- * different aroma/flavour.

So:

- > lemon = 檸檬
- > lime = 青檸 / 萊姆

They are different fruits.

Important distinction: **lemon vs citron**

lemon

common everyday citrus fruit.

citron

a different citrus fruit, usually larger with a thick rind.

So **citron** is not simply a formal synonym for **lemon**.

Important distinction: **lemon** vs **lemony**

lemon

noun:

> lemon juice

lemony

adjective:

> lemony smell

= 有檸檬香氣的

Something can taste **lemony** without containing actual lemon.

Important distinction: **lemon** vs **lemonade**

lemon

fruit.

lemonade

prepared drink made/flavoured with lemon.

> lemon = 檸檬

> lemonade = 檸檬水 / 檸檬汽水

Important distinction: **a lemon** vs **defective**

a lemon

informal, vivid.

> “That car is a lemon.”

defective

neutral/formal adjective.

> “The car is defective.”

Both indicate problems, but **a lemon** often implies the product was a bad purchase because it has repeated or serious defects.

Important distinction: **lemon law vs warranty**

warranty

= seller/manufacturer’s contractual promise to repair, replace, etc.

lemon law

= legal consumer protection that may provide remedies for qualifying defective products/vehicles.

They can interact, but they are not the same thing.

Important distinction: **lemon colour vs yellow**

yellow

broad colour category.

lemon / lemon yellow

a particular bright/light yellow associated with lemon peel.

So:

> lemon shirt

may describe a specific shade rather than the fruit.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern family includes:

* **lemon — fruit** = 檸檬
* **lemon tree** = 檸檬樹
* **lemon — colour** = 檸檬黃
* **a lemon — defective product** = 問題產品 / 次貨
* **lemon law** = 檸檬法 / 瑕疵產品保障法
* **lemony** = 有檸檬味 / 香氣的
* **lemonade** = 檸檬水 / 檸檬飲品
* **lemon juice** = 檸檬汁
* **lemon zest** = 檸檬皮屑
* **lemon curd** = 檸檬凝乳醬
* **when life gives you lemons...** = 把逆境轉化為機會

I would stop there rather than list every transparent food compound containing **lemon**.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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lemon — fruit	一種黃色、味酸、果汁豐富的柑橘類水果
lemon tree	結出檸檬果實的柑橘類果樹
lemon — colour	類似檸檬果皮的明亮 / 偏淡黃色
a lemon — defective product	購買後發現品質很差、故障頻繁或有重大缺陷的產品，尤指汽車
lemon law	為購買到符合特定條件的嚴重瑕疵產品 / 車輛的消費者提供法律補救的制度
lemony	味道或香氣帶有明顯檸檬特徵的
lemonade	以檸檬汁 / 檸檬味製成的飲品
lemon juice	從檸檬果肉擠出的汁液
lemon zest	檸檬外層黃色果皮磨成的細屑
lemon curd	以檸檬、糖、蛋等製成的濃稠甜酸醬
when life gives you lemons...	面對逆境時設法利用現有條件，把不利情況轉化成正面結果

For your original sentence

> “She also has a few fruit plants, especially strawberries and a small **lemon tree**.”

The exact meaning is:

lemon = 用來指出這是一棵結出檸檬果實的樹

So:

> **lemon tree**

= **「檸檬樹」**

Natural full translation:

> **「她也種了一些水果植物，尤其是草莓，還有一棵小小的檸檬樹。」**

The highest-value polysemy contrast is:

> **lemon** → 檸檬

> **lemon** → 檸檬黃色

> **a lemon** → 有嚴重毛病的問題產品 / 次貨

> **lemon law** → 保護問題車 / 瑕疵產品消費者的法律制度

> **lemony** → 帶檸檬味 / 香氣的

> **lemonade** → 檸檬飲品